

KB0002 — MFA Enrollment and Troubleshooting

Category: Identity & Access Management

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Owner: Security Operations

Overview

Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA) is enforced for all corporate logins. This article covers enrollment, common failures, and recovery for Okta Verify, Google Authenticator, and hardware tokens (YubiKey).

Symptoms

- "Invalid code" when entering MFA token
 - MFA prompt appears in loop after correct code entry
 - Authenticator app shows different code than expected
 - User lost/replaced device with authenticator app
 - YubiKey not recognized
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Root Causes

1. **Time drift on authenticator app** — TOTP codes are time-based; device clock drift >30s causes failures.
 2. **Old factor not removed** — Previous device's MFA factor still active, causing confusion.
 3. **Push notification not delivered** — Okta push blocked by corporate firewall or notification settings.
 4. **YubiKey firmware incompatibility** — Older YubiKey 4 series not supported after 2025 policy update.
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Resolution Steps

Time Drift Fix (Most Common)

1. On Android: Settings → Date & Time → Enable "Use network-provided time"
2. On iOS: Settings → General → Date & Time → Set Automatically ON
3. Re-open authenticator app and try the new code

Reset MFA Factor via Okta Admin

```
Okta Admin → Directory → People → [Search User] → Security tab →  
→ Under "Enrolled Factors" → Click Reset next to affected factor
```

Re-Enroll Authenticator App

1. After factor reset, user visits: <https://sso.corp.internal/enduser/profile>
2. Click "Set up" under Okta Verify or Google Authenticator
3. Scan QR code with new device
4. Verify with 6-digit code

YubiKey Re-Registration

```
# Admin: Remove old YubiKey from Okta profile  
curl -X DELETE https://<okta-  
domain>/api/v1/users/<userId>/factors/<factorId> \  
-H "Authorization: SSWS <api_token>"
```

Then re-register via Okta Admin → Security → Multifactor → YubiKey

Push Notification Not Delivering

- Ensure Okta Verify app has notification permissions
- Whitelist push.okta.com on firewall/proxy
- Fallback: use TOTP code mode instead of push

Escalation

- Hardware token issues → Security Ops team with Jira ticket

- Persistent loop after code entry → Likely Okta session issue, clear browser cookies + incognito test
 - If user cannot enroll any factor → Check if Okta account is suspended
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Related Articles

- KB0001 — Password Reset & Account Unlock Procedures
- KB0003 — VPN Authentication Issues